FAMILY TRIP · OCTOBER 2026

China — 16 days

Auckland → Beijing → Xi'an → Shanghai → Auckland · via Hong Kong · Cathay Pacific

Prices are in CNY with approximate NZD alongside (about NZ$0.25 per ¥1, mid-market rate from August 2026 — real card and ATM rates will differ).

16	3	6	Oct 13	Oct 29
days	cities	travellers	depart AKL	return AKL

Vincent · Jeremy · Sharon · Tom · Dad · Mum

CONFIRMED FLIGHTS & TRAINS

11:15 Auckland → Hong Kong
CX7402 · Tue 13 Oct · Boeing 787-9 · operated by Air New Zealand · 1h15m connection

19:00 Hong Kong → Beijing
CX344 · Tue 13 Oct · Airbus A330-300 · arrive 22:25

09:55 Beijing West → Xi'an North
G365 high-speed train · Mon 19 Oct · arrive 14:05 · booked via Trip.com

08:30 Xi'an → Shanghai Pudong
HU7845 Hainan Airlines · Fri 23 Oct · Xianyang T3 → Pudong T2 · arrive 11:00 · ref NV485F

07:55 Shanghai Hongqiao → Nanjing South
G452 high-speed train · Sun 25 Oct · arrive 08:56 · booked via Trip.com

21:59 Nanjing South → Shanghai Hongqiao
G1785 high-speed train · Sun 25 Oct · arrive 23:30 · booked via Trip.com

13:35 Shanghai → Hong Kong
CX349 · Wed 28 Oct · Airbus A330-300 · 5h15m layover (airside)

21:35 Hong Kong → Auckland
CX113 · Wed 28 Oct · Airbus A350-900 · arrive Thu 29 Oct 13:25

Beijing
13–19 Oct
6
nights · Days 1–6

Xi'an
19–23 Oct
4
nights · Days 7–10

Shanghai
23–28 Oct
5
nights · Days 11–16

KEY BOOKINGS — DO THESE IN ADVANCE

- 🏰 Shanghai Disneyland tickets (Mon 26 Oct, 3 tickets)
- 🧩 AURORA escape room, Shanghai (Tue 27 Oct 20:20, 3 players — email first)
- 🏛️ Shaanxi History Museum (free — book online)

DAY 1 · TUE 13 OCT

✈️ Depart Auckland

Transit ✈️ Overnight flight

LOCKED IN

11:15 Auckland → Hong Kong

19:00 Hong Kong → Beijing

11:15 Auckland → Hong Kong

~11h 30m ✓ Booked

FLIGHT	CX7402 · operated by Air New Zealand
AIRCRAFT	Boeing 787-9
ARRIVES	Hong Kong 17:45

Tight 1h15m connection in Hong Kong — no time to leave the terminal.

19:00 Hong Kong → Beijing

~3h 25m ✓ Booked

FLIGHT	CX344 · Airbus A330-300
ARRIVES	Beijing Capital 22:25

Late-night arrival — straight to the hotel and check in.

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Beijing Capital Airport
- Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)

🏨 **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing** — late night arrival

← Overview | Day 2 →

DAY 2 · WED 14 OCT

Arrive Beijing — Summer Palace & soft landing

Arrival · Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing

LOCKED IN

Afternoon Summer Palace guided tour

17:40 Red Theatre acrobatic show

Red Theatre, No. 44 Xingfu Street, Dongcheng District. Subway: Line 5 to Temple of Heaven East Gate (exit B), then about 1 km on foot — or take a...

MORNING

- Arrived late previous night at 22:25 — sleep in to recover, no rush
- Jeremy is already checked in (he arrives earlier from Sydney); the rest of us will take a DiDi from Capital Airport directly to the hotel — straightforward ride, no need for pre-arranged transfers

AFTERNOON

Afternoon **Summer Palace guided tour** ~2.5 hrs ✓ Booked

TOUR	English guide · afternoon session (exact start TBC)
ENTRY	East Palace Gate
INCLUDED	Admission + Kunming Lake cruise
COST	CNY 1,308 / ~NZ$327 (4 adult + 2 senior) — about ¥218 / ~NZ$55 pp on average
BOOKING	#1486591927947958
CANCEL	Free until 17:00 on 13 Oct

Summer Palace (Yiheyuan) — boat ride on Kunming Lake, Long Corridor painted galleries and Longevity Hill pavilions; a gentle first taste of imperial Beijing.

- Wangfujing pedestrian street on the way back for street food snacks and a first feel of the city

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Summer Palace — East Palace Gate**
- **Wangfujing pedestrian street**

🌙 EVENING

17:40 **Red Theatre acrobatic show** ~1.5 hrs ✓ Booked

TICKETS	6 · Green section, mid rows 14–16
WHERE	Red Theatre, No. 44 Xingfu Street, Dongcheng District. Subway: Line 5 to Temple of Heaven East Gate (exit B), then about 1 km on foot — or take a taxi/DiDi from the hotel
COLLECT	Front desk in the Main Hall — show the confirmation message to get your physical tickets. Staff will contact you by 16:00
CONTACT	+86 186 0020 8126 · WeChat lucy18600208126
COST	CNY 2,568 / ~NZ$642 — ¥428 / ~NZ$107 pp
BOOKING	#1486591927971168

Chinese acrobatics, contortion and aerial acts — one of the best variety shows in Beijing. Dad

- Dinner after the show nearby, then a taxi or DiDi back to the hotel to settle in

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Red Theatre
- Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)

🏨 **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing**

← Day 1 Day 3 →

DAY 3 · THU 15 OCT

Great Wall at Mutianyu — full day

Beijing 🏨 Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing

LOCKED IN

08:30 **Mutianyu Great Wall**
08:30 · Xuanwumen Subway Station Exit G (listing also notes 08:00 at Zhushikou Exit D — confirm in travel notification)

MORNING & AFTERNOON

08:30 Mutianyu Great Wall

~5 hrs on site · ✓ Booked

MEET	08:30 · Xuanwumen Subway Station Exit G (listing also notes 08:00 at Zhushikou Exit D — confirm in travel notification)
INCLUDED	Ticket, round-trip shuttle, round-trip cable car, coach from Beijing
RETURN	Coach drops near the Bird's Nest & Water Cube after ~5 hrs at the Wall, then metro/DiDi to the hotel
BRING	Passports — ID required
COST	CNY 1,530 / ~NZ$382 · 6 tickets · ¥255 / ~NZ$64 pp
BOOKING	#1486591928109095
CANCEL	Free until 18:00 on 14 Oct

Mutianyu is the right section: fewer crowds than Badaling, well-restored, beautiful valley setting.

- Cable car up to the wall — saves legs for the ridge walk between watchtowers
- Mid-October foliage in the surrounding forest is at or near peak — the colours from the wall are extraordinary
- Optional toboggan run back down — fast, fun, good for the group
- Walking the full ridge between towers is a legitimate hike with real elevation changes

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Xuanwumen subway station, Exit G (coach meeting point)**
- **Mutianyu Great Wall**

EVENING

- Olympic Park at dusk — the coach drops you beside the Bird's Nest and Water Cube, which light up after dark; an easy, flat stroll across the open plaza after a big day on the Wall (suggestion, nothing to book)
- Dinner: Beijing-style copper-pot lamb hotpot (涮羊肉) nearby or back near the hotel — warming after the Wall, and walk-in is fine
- Early night — Day 4 starts early at Tiananmen Square

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Bird's Nest (coach drop-off, Olympic Park)**
- **Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)**

🏨 Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing

← Day 2 Day 4 →

DAY 4 · FRI 16 OCT

Tiananmen Square, Forbidden City & Jingshan Park

Beijing 🏨 Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing

LOCKED IN

10:00 **Forbidden City small-group tour**
Ticket gate at the Meridian Gate. Listed entry window 08:30–09:00 (a 12:30–13:30 window is also listed) — the guide contacts you the day before to…

MORNING

- Early start — Tiananmen Square at opening for photos before crowds build

10:00 Forbidden City small-group tour

~3 hrs (est.) · ✓ Booked

TOUR	Treasure Hall + Clock Hall · small group · English guide · tickets included
WHO	4 adults + 2 seniors (all six)
MEET	Ticket gate at the Meridian Gate. Listed entry window 08:30–09:00 (a 12:30–13:30 window is also listed) — the guide contacts you the day before to confirm
BRING	Passports (the ID used for booking)
BOOKING	#1486591937937097
SUPPORT	WeChat 18510913636

Small-group in-depth tour with an English-speaking guide, covering the Treasure Hall and Clock Hall, with entry tickets included. Allow the whole morning — the scale genuinely needs time, don't rush it.

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Forbidden City — Meridian Gate**
- **Tiananmen Square**

AFTERNOON

- Jingshan Park directly north — the hilltop pavilion gives the single best overhead view of the Forbidden City's golden rooftops in Beijing
- Almost no Western tourists here despite being extraordinary — Dad, Jeremy, and Vincent bring cameras

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Jingshan Park**

🌙 EVENING

- Peking duck dinner near Wangfujing — find a well-regarded local restaurant on the day, not a tourist trap
- Nanluoguxiang hutong wander after dinner — lantern-lit alley lined with indie shops, bars, and snack stalls; one of the most atmospheric old streets in Beijing

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Wangfujing pedestrian street**
- **Nanluoguxiang**
- **Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)**

🏨 **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing**

← Day 3 | Day 5 →

DAY 5 · SAT 17 OCT

Temple of Heaven, noodle class, Zhongguancun & 798 Art District

Beijing 🏨 Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing

LOCKED IN

10:30 **Hand-Pulled Noodles class**
The Hutong, 东城区九道湾中巷1号, Beijing 100007 — show the Chinese address to your driver

MORNING

- Very early start — Temple of Heaven park at 7am: locals doing tai chi, flying kites, playing erhu, completely unscripted
- The light on the Hall of Prayer at that hour is one of the best photography opportunities in Asia — Vincent, Jeremy, and Dad bring cameras

10:30 Hand-Pulled Noodles class

2.5 hrs · ✓ Booked

WHO	Vincent, Sharon, Jeremy, Tom (4 adults)
WHEN	Sat 17 Oct, 10:30–13:00
WHERE	The Hutong, 东城区九道湾中巷1号, Beijing 100007 — show the Chinese address to your driver
TEACHER	Sophia
COST	CNY 1,400 / ~NZ$350 total (¥350 / ~NZ$88 pp) · **paid ✓**
BOOKING	#31610091176251
CONTACT	+86 159 0104 6127 · WeChat TheHutongEducation · events@thehutong.com

Learn to pull Lamian noodles from scratch and prepare a Xinjiang sauce. Small-group, English-language, finishing with lunch.

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Temple of Heaven**
- **The Hutong (noodle class)**

☀️ AFTERNOON

- **Zhongguancun Electronics District** (Haidian) — Beijing's version of Akihabara, spread across several interconnected malls; phone repair shops (good for iPhone battery replacement — ¥120–200 / ~NZ$30–50 for a genuine battery, same day), keyboard and peripheral stalls, retro handhelds (Anbernic, Powkiddy), and Chinese-market tech that doesn't reach NZ. An hour here is more than enough unless you want to go deep
- 798 Art District for Cold War-era factory architecture, outdoor sculpture, and street art — great for photography and design interest; 15-minute taxi from Zhongguancun
- 🎴 **Pokémon TCG Gym, Xidan Joy City** — B1 floor, Xidan Joy City mall: China's licensed equivalent of a Pokémon Center, with dedicated play areas, regional decor, and a huge inventory of Simplified Chinese TCG cards and exclusives Vincent

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Zhongguancun electronics district
- 798 Art District
- Xidan Joy City (Pokémon gym)

🌙 EVENING

- Optional late night: Guijie Ghost Street hotpot — restaurants open until 3am, zero tourists

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Guijie (Ghost Street) hotpot
- Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)

🏨 **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing**

← Day 4 | Day 6 →

DAY 6 · SUN 18 OCT

Beijing Wildlife Park & Panjiayuan market

Beijing 🏨 Chongwenmen Hotel — last night

🌄 MORNING

- 🐼 **Beijing Wildlife Park** — 3,600-acre safari park in Daxing; Africa-themed zones, giant panda enclosure, elephant walk, and a self-drive safari circuit where animals roam freely around your vehicle; opens 8:30am, allow 3–4 hours (¥80 / ~NZ$20 adults, safari ride ¥20 / ~NZ$5 extra) Sharon
  - Take subway Line 4 to Tiangongyuan then the dedicated park bus, or arrange a car — about 50 min from the hotel

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Beijing Wildlife Park

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Panjiayuan antique and craft market — Sunday is the best day; thousands of stalls selling everything from antique furniture to embroidery, ceramics and jade; great for Mum and Sharon (southwest Beijing, reasonable from Daxing via ring road)

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Panjiayuan market
- Chongwenmen Hotel (Beijing)

🏨 **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing** — last night

← Day 5 | Day 7 →

DAY 7 · MON 19 OCT

🚄 Beijing → Xi'an by bullet train

Transit 🏨 AHS-Park Hotel — first night

LOCKED IN

09:55 G365 Beijing West → Xi'an North

09:55 **G365 Beijing West → Xi'an North** 4h 10m ✓ Booked

TRAIN	G365 high-speed · arrives Xi'an North 14:05
BOOKED VIA	Trip.com
BEFORE	Check out of the Beijing hotel before departure

Arrive 14:05 — metro/taxi to the hotel, drop bags or check in.

~15:30 **Shaanxi History Museum** ~1.5 hrs Need to book

ENTRY	Free — timed ticket booked online (WeChat mini-program or official site); slots fill within days
PLAN	Arrive ~15:30 after the train; closes 17:00
BOOK	**Official museum site ↗**

One of China's finest museums — Tang dynasty gold treasures, silk road artefacts and terracotta warrior originals; particularly outstanding for Tom and Dad.

- ✈ Late afternoon / early evening: walk the top of the ancient City Wall for a first look at its scale
- 📌 Evening: Muslim Quarter for dinner and street food — lanterns, steam from food stalls, red-lit alleyways
- 📌 Excellent night photography — Jeremy, Vincent, and Dad bring cameras

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Beijing West Station
- Xi'an North Station
- Shaanxi History Museum
- Xi'an City Wall
- Muslim Quarter
- AHS-Park Hotel (Xi'an, Bell Tower)

🏨 **AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an** — first night

← Day 6 Day 8 →

DAY 8 · TUE 20 OCT

Terracotta Warriors — English-guided morning tour

Xi'an 🏨 AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an

LOCKED IN

07:40 **Terracotta Warriors tour**
07:40 door-to-door at the hotel — times can change, check the travel notification the evening before

🌄 MORNING

07:40 **Terracotta Warriors tour** ⏱ Morning (~5 hrs) ✓ Booked

TOUR	English-guided carpool · morning option · 6 adults · no Huaqing Palace visit
PICK-UP	07:40 door-to-door at the hotel — times can change, check the travel notification the evening before
INCLUDED	Entry to the Mausoleum of Qin Shi Huang
COST	CNY 1,860 / ~NZ$465 — ¥310 / ~NZ$78 pp
BOOKING	#1486591928609715
CANCEL	Free until 22:00 on 19 Oct

Visit all three pits plus the bronze chariot museum — ask the guide to cover Pits 2 and 3, not just Pit 1; they're less crowded and equally fascinating.

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Terracotta Army Museum

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Back in Xi'an after the morning tour (carpool drop-off time per travel notification) — afternoon free: rest, or explore the Muslim Quarter / City Wall

🌙 EVENING

- Dinner: fresh biang biang noodles at a local canteen — watch the cook hand-pull the noodles from a single lump of dough

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Muslim Quarter
- AHS-Park Hotel (Xi'an, Bell Tower)

🏨 **AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an**

← Day 7 Day 9 →

DAY 9 · WED 21 OCT

Mount Huashan — West Peak cable car & South Peak

Xi'an · AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an

LOCKED IN

07:00 **Mount Hua group tour (West Peak)**

06:50–07:30 (senior 07:00–07:20) from addresses inside Xi'an's second ring road, which includes the hotel — confirm it with the supplier. Or go…

MORNING

07:00 Mount Hua group tour (West Peak)

Full day (return time TBC) ✓ Booked

WHO	Vincent, Jeremy, Sharon, Tom (adults) + Dad (senior) — Mum has a free day
INCLUDED	Park admission, round-trip West Peak cable car (incl. the cable car bus) and a round-trip coach between Xi'an and the mountain — replaces the separate train, park and cable car tickets
PICK-UP	06:50–07:30 (senior 07:00–07:20) from addresses inside Xi'an's second ring road, which includes the hotel — confirm it with the supplier. Or go yourselves to the Qinzhifeng departure yard at Shijiajie station (Line 3), exit C1, 07:45–08:00
BE EARLY	10 minutes before pick-up — late arrivals may be refused
BRING	Passports — real-name check, entry is refused without ID
NOTE	You must travel on the group coach; you can't meet at the mountain entrance. Entry time depends on when the coach arrives
CONTACT	Supplier 029-82498353 / 029-89284460
COST	On the Trip.com e-receipt (not in the confirmation email)
BOOKING	#1486592033825069

Cable car up to West Peak (2,082m) and back down, with time on the mountain set by the group coach. The return time isn't stated, so check with the supplier before planning the afternoon.

- If the group's schedule allows: walk West Peak → South Peak (~600m, ~30 min) — the summit at 2,154m is the highest point on the mountain with panoramic views across the Shaanxi plains
- Optional Plank Walk from South Peak: a narrow wooden ledge bolted to a sheer cliff face — harness hire ~¥30 / ~NZ$7.5, not required, entirely at the group's comfort level
- Walk back South Peak → West Peak (~40 min), then the cable car down to meet the coach on time

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Shijiajie subway station, Exit C1 (Mount Hua coach meeting point)**
- **Mount Hua**

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Back in Xi'an once the coach returns (time not stated on the booking) — quick rest and a late lunch at the hotel or nearby
- **If you're back by ~3:00pm: City Wall bike ride** — hire bikes at the South or North gate (¥45 / ~NZ$11 pp for 100 min) and ride the full 14km loop atop the Ming-dynasty walls; the afternoon light in October turns the ancient stone a warm amber, and the city views in both directions are superb

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Xi'an City Wall (bike hire)**

🌙 EVENING

- Dinner in the Muslim Quarter: lamb skewers, persimmon cakes, biangbiang noodles

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Muslim Quarter**
- **AHS-Park Hotel (Xi'an, Bell Tower)**

🏨 **AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an**

← Day 8 | Day 10 →

DAY 10 · THU 22 OCT

Xi'an free day — City Wall, Tang Paradise & last night

Xi'an 🏨 AHS-Park Hotel — last night

🌄 MORNING

- Flexible day — no fixed plans, decide on the morning what feels right after Huashan
- Option: City Wall bike ride — 14km loop atop the Ming-dynasty walls, sunrise light is magical

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Xi'an City Wall**

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Option: Big Wild Goose Pagoda — centuries-old Buddhist pagoda, vast square with fountain show at dusk

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Big Wild Goose Pagoda**

🌙 EVENING — TANG PARADISE

- **Tang Paradise** (大唐芙蓉园) — a vast Tang dynasty-themed garden park; entry ¥120 / ~NZ$30 pp
- Arrive ~19:00 to explore the illuminated gardens, replica palaces, and lakeside pavilions before the main show
- Optional paid indoor performance: *"Dreaming Back to the Great Tang"* at 17:00–18:00 in the Fengming Jiutian Theater — immersive dance and acrobatics show (separate ticket required)
- **Main spectacle — 20:30–21:00:** *"Chasing the Dream of the Great Tang"* at the North Square of Purple Cloud Tower — a large-scale outdoor water, light, dance, and shadow projection show set to music; free with park entry and worth planning the whole evening around
- Allow 2–3 hours total in the park; the gardens are stunning at night with full illuminations
- Final Xi'an dinner before or after in the Muslim Quarter — spiced lamb skewers, rose jelly (méiguī bīng fěn), persimmon cakes

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Tang Paradise**
- **Muslim Quarter**
- **AHS-Park Hotel (Xi'an, Bell Tower)**

🏨 **AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an** — last night

← Day 9 | Day 11 →

DAY 11 · FRI 23 OCT

✈️ Xi'an → Shanghai + Bund at dusk

Transit 🏨 JI Hotel The Bund — first night

LOCKED IN

08:30 Xi'an → Shanghai Pudong

08:30 **Xi'an → Shanghai Pudong** ⏱ 2h 30m ✓ Booked

FLIGHT	HU7845 Hainan Airlines · Economy · 6 pax
ROUTE	Xianyang T3 08:30 → Pudong T2 11:00
LEAVE HOTEL	By ~05:45 — airport is ~50 min from the Bell Tower
BOOKING	#1486591468940666 · airline ref NV485F

Land at Pudong T2 at 11:00 — Metro Line 2 into the city to the hotel, check in or drop bags.

- ✈ Afternoon: cross to Pudong via Metro Line 2 — **Binjiang Park** on the east bank of the Huangpu; this is the riverside promenade looking directly west across the river at the Bund and Puxi skyline; completely free, almost no tourist crowds, and the view is better than from the Bund side itself because you have the full sweep of art deco buildings with the water between you. Best in late afternoon light on the way to the rooftop bar. Dad, Jeremy, Vincent — cameras out
- 📌 This is the panoramic shot someone recommended — east of the river. If the weather's poor today, Day 12 dawn at the Bund is the backup, and the view also works from Day 15's Science Museum/Pudong afternoon
- ✈ First Bund walk on the way back — orientation, skyline in both directions
- 📌 Evening: rooftop bar (Bar Rouge, New Heights, or Flair) for blue hour — the towers light up as the sky darkens
- 📌 Jeremy, Vincent, and Dad: this is the iconic Bund dusk shot — bring cameras

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Xi'an Xianyang Airport, Terminal 3
- Shanghai Pudong Airport, Terminal 2

- Binjiang Park (Pudong riverside)
- The Bund
- JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)

> 🏨 **JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai** — first night

← Day 10 | Day 12 →

DAY 12 · SAT 24 OCT

Bund at dawn, French Concession & west Puxi

Shanghai 🏨 JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai

🌇 MORNING

- Very early: Bund at 6:30am — almost tourist-free, golden light on the art deco facades, Pudong skyline reflected in still water
- Best photography window of the entire Shanghai leg — Vincent, Jeremy, and Dad bring cameras
- Mid-morning: French Concession wander into **Xintiandi** — start on the tree-lined Art Deco streets of the Concession, then walk south into Xintiandi's two blocks of restored 1920s shikumen lane houses: upscale cafés, independent boutiques, good lunch options. The architecture is intact at street level in a way you won't see anywhere else in Shanghai. 30 minutes of wandering is plenty; have lunch here before splitting into groups for the afternoon
- 💄 **HARMAY (话梅) beauty store, Xintiandi** — a Hong Kong-founded beauty and skincare retailer known for its wet-market-style store design, with a huge range of Asian and international brands. Right in Xintiandi, so easy to do before lunch. Confirm the exact address and opening hours on Amap or Dianping before going Sharon

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- ▸ **The Bund**
- ▸ **Xintiandi**
- ▸ **HARMAY beauty store, Xintiandi**

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Tianzifang alleyways for Sharon and Mum — independent boutiques, textile shops, handmade jewellery (a short metro or taxi from Xintiandi)
- Vincent and Jeremy: **Baisihao Electronics City, Xujiahui** (Metro Lines 1/9/11, Exit 1) — stalls selling Anbernic/Powkiddy handhelds, keyboards, switches, keycaps and Onyx Boox e-readers at factory-adjacent prices; a short taxi or metro ride from Tianzifang, on the same side of town
- 🎴 **Pokémon TCG Gym, Cloud Nine Mall** — 3F, Longemont Shopping Park, Changning District (Zhongshan Park Station Exit 5): China-only merchandise, 151-series items and statues (open 10:00–22:00) Vincent
- 🎴 **Cramorant Gym** (古月鸟 Gym) — also at Dragon's Dream mall, Zhongshan Park (Metro Lines 2/3/4 Exit 8), same complex as Cloud Nine; newly renovated 2025, specialises in official booster boxes and Japanese-format play; combine both on the same Zhongshan Park stop. Neighbouring district to Xujiahui — a short taxi from Baisihao Vincent
- M50 Moganshan Road art district for Vincent and Sharon — 100+ open studios, ceramics workshops and galleries in converted factories. It's in the neighbouring Putuo district, a short taxi from Zhongshan Park. Studios and galleries usually close around 18:00, so aim to arrive by about 16:30 and check opening times first. Sharon can head straight there from Tianzifang

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Tianzifang**
- **Longemont mall (Cloud Nine gym), Zhongshan Park**
- **Cramorant Gym (Dragon's Dream, Zhongshan Park)**
- **M50 art district**

🌙 EVENING

- Free evening — dinner wherever looks good; nothing booked

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)**

🏨 **JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai**

← Day 11 | Day 13 →

DAY 13 · SUN 25 OCT

Nanjing day trip — Ming tombs, city walls & Qinhuai River at night

Shanghai · JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai

LOCKED IN

07:55 **G452 Shanghai Hongqiao → Nanjing South**
Hongqiao ticket gate 16A/16B (can change — check the app). Be at the station at least 60 minutes before, so leave the hotel by about 06:00

21:59 **G1785 Nanjing South → Shanghai Hongqiao**
Nanjing South ticket gate A12 (can change). Leave the Qinhuai area by about 20:45 to be at the station an hour early

MORNING

07:55 **G452 Shanghai Hongqiao → Nanjing South** 1h 01m ✓ Booked

WHO	All six · 2nd class
ARRIVE	Nanjing South 08:56
GATE	Hongqiao ticket gate 16A/16B (can change — check the app). Be at the station at least 60 minutes before, so leave the hotel by about 06:00
SEATS	Car-seat: Vincent 13-003F · Tom 13-002D · Sharon 13-002C · Dad 13-003A · Mum 11-010D · Jeremy 12-015F (not all together)
COST	CNY 1,020 / ~NZ$255 for 6 (incl. booking fee) — ¥170 / ~NZ$43 pp
BOOKING	#1486592527640427

High-speed train out of Hongqiao. Enter the station with your passports — no paper ticket needed.

Morning **Sun Yat-sen Mausoleum** ~2 hrs Need to book

ENTRY	Free — reservation required (1–7 days ahead)
BOOK	Nanjing Tourism WeChat mini-program or Trip.com; Ming Xiaoling nearby needs booking ~3 days ahead

392 steps through a forested hillside to a spectacular hilltop tomb; crowds are lighter in the morning.

- Ming Xiaoling Mausoleum nearby — Sacred Way lined with stone animal statues, one of China's best-preserved imperial burial sites

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Shanghai Hongqiao Railway Station
- Nanjing South Railway Station
- Sun Yat-sen Mausoleum
- Ming Xiaoling Mausoleum

☀️ AFTERNOON

- Nanjing City Wall — the longest surviving ancient city wall in the world (35km); take the wall walk near Zhonghua Gate for the best section
- Zhonghua Gate fortress — six-century-old gate castle with hidden tunnels and soldier vaults cut into the walls, a highlight for Tom and Dad
- Late afternoon: wander into the old town lanes south of the gate to rest before the evening

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Zhonghua Gate**

🌙 EVENING

- 🏮 **Qinhuai River Scenic Area (Confucius Temple)** — the entire riverfront lights up at dusk with red lanterns, ornate bridges and reflected neon on the water; best views from the boats and the bridge walkways (open until 10pm) Vincent
- Dinner in the Confucius Temple food street — try Nanjing duck (the city's signature dish), small wontons and osmanthus rice cakes

21:59 **G1785 Nanjing South → Shanghai Hongqiao** 1h 31m ✓ Booked

WHO	All six · 2nd class
ARRIVE	Hongqiao 23:30
GATE	Nanjing South ticket gate A12 (can change). Leave the Qinhuai area by about 20:45 to be at the station an hour early
SEATS	Car-seat: Vincent 05-004D · Tom 05-005D · Sharon 05-004B · Dad 05-004F · Mum 05-005B · Jeremy 05-005A
COST	CNY 942 / ~NZ$236 for 6 (incl. booking fee) — ¥157 / ~NZ$39 pp
BOOKING	#1486592527656735

Gets you to Hongqiao at 23:30, roughly 45 minutes from the hotel by taxi, so a very late night before Disney the next morning.

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Confucius Temple / Qinhuai River**
- **Nanjing South Railway Station (return train)**
- **Shanghai Hongqiao Railway Station (arrival)**
- **JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)**

🏨 JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai

← Day 12 Day 14 →

DAY 14 · MON 26 OCT

Shanghai Disneyland — full day

Shanghai 🏨 JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai

MORNING & AFTERNOON

~09:00 **Shanghai Disneyland** Full day **Need to book**

WHO	Vincent, Tom, Sharon (3 tickets) — Jeremy, Dad and Mum have a free day
TICKETS	Online — rolling 30-day calendar; Monday is the quietest day of the week
COST	¥499 / ~NZ$125 pp for a standard one-day ticket (ages 12–59) — ¥1,497 / ~NZ$374 for 3. Price varies by date: Mon 26 Oct is among the cheapest days, weekends run ¥569–689 / ~NZ$142–172. Max 5 tickets per order
TIMING	Gates open around 08:00. We get back from Nanjing near midnight the night before, so a 09:00 arrival is fine — then stay for the fireworks
BOOK	**Shanghai Disney tickets ↗**

Head straight to Zootopia: Hot Pursuit (queues hit 90–120 min by mid-morning, the world's only Zootopia land), then TRON Lightcycle Power Run — exclusive to Shanghai. Check the app for live wait times.

- Pirates of the Caribbean — the best version in the world: trackless boat, seamless projections, stunning scale
- The castle is the tallest Disney has ever built
- Fully bilingual park — all signage, ride instructions, and cast members operate in English
- Jeremy, Dad and Mum: free day — rest or wander at your own pace

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

▸ **Shanghai Disneyland**

EVENING

- Stay for the castle nighttime spectacular, fireworks, and final parade — the park comes alive after dark

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

▸ **JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)**

JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai

← Day 13 Day 15 →

DAY 15 · TUE 27 OCT

Old Town, hairy crab lunch, Science Museum & escape room finale

Shanghai JI Hotel The Bund — last night

MORNING

- **Yu Garden & Old Town** (豫园) — a 16th-century Ming dynasty garden in the heart of the old city; ¥40 / ~NZ$10 pp; ornamental rockwork, dragon-topped pavilion walls, koi ponds, and covered walkways. Go early (open 8:30am) before the afternoon tour groups arrive. The surrounding Yuyuan Bazaar is touristy but the food stalls are excellent — xiaolongbao, pan-fried pork buns, and osmanthus cake. A 10-minute walk to/from the hotel

- 🎴 **JE宝可梦卡牌** — Room 212, Baimi Xiangxie, Guangxi North Road, Huangpu (near Nanjing East Road metro): dedicated Japanese PTCG singles dealer, the best source for individual Japanese cards in Shanghai; Wednesday night tournaments at 19:30. Worth visiting in the morning while the group is in the Yu Garden / Old Town area — same neighbourhood, 10-minute walk Vincent

- After Yu Garden: split by interest — Sharon and Tom: wet market wander; Vincent and Jeremy: AP Xinyang Market (see afternoon); Mum and Sharon: South Bund Fabric Market for bargain shopping

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Yu Garden**
- **JE Pokémon cards (Guangxi North Road)**
- **South Bund Fabric Market**

AFTERNOON

~12:30 **Hairy crab lunch** ~1.5 hrs **Need to book**

RESERVE Table for 6 at a local restaurant, booked in advance

Late October is peak hairy crab season in Shanghai — one of China's great seasonal food events.

- Vincent and Jeremy: **AP Xinyang Market, Science Museum station** (same Metro stop as the science museum) for tech accessories and components

- **Shanghai Science and Technology Museum** (上海科技馆) — Metro Line 2, SSTM Station (Exit 7/8); ¥45 / ~NZ$11 adults; open Tue–Sun 9:00–17:15; multiple floors covering robotics, space, earth sciences, life sciences, and three IMAX theatres; particularly strong for Tom; if the Binjiang Park view didn't happen on Day 11, this is in the same Pudong neighbourhood — easy to combine

SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- **Shanghai Science and Technology Museum**

🌙 EVENING

- Final Shanghai dinner — last night in China, so make it count; finish by about 19:30 to reach the escape room for 20:20. The Bund-facing restaurants in the JI Hotel neighbourhood, or book ahead for a rooftop view across the river

20:20 **AURORA escape room (Mr. & Mrs. Jawn)** ⏱ 115 min **Need to book**

SUGGESTED	Tue 27 Oct, 20:20–22:15 — after the final dinner, then back to the hotel around 23:00. Alternatives: 19:15–21:10 or 21:25–23:20 (all CNY 288 / ~NZ$72 pp)
WHO	Vincent, Sharon, Tom (3 players) — the room is 4–7, so **email first** to hold a table: xingkuan50@gmail.com
WHERE	屋有岛 (ARK新华店) · 5F Huaning Hongji Life Plaza, No. 300 Xuanhua Road, Changning District — about 25–30 min from the hotel by taxi
ROOM	AURORA (Chapter One) · English edition · non-horror
COST	CNY 288 / ~NZ$72 pp (CNY 864 / ~NZ$216 for 3) — no deposit, pay by Alipay QR or cash on arrival
BOOK	**mrandmrsjawn.com/book** → Shanghai, English, 27 Oct (3 players needs an email to the studio first). Confirmation email with booking code within 24 hrs
CANCEL	Free 48+ hrs before · 50% refund 24–48 hrs · none inside 24 hrs
WEAR	Sports shoes and trousers (light climbing and reaching); lockers available
NEXT DAY	Flight CX349 leaves Hongqiao at 13:35 — check out by late morning

A big mechanical fantasy room — a sword that has waited a thousand years and a sleeping dragon — with anime-style visuals and effects (2023 EGA Shanghai Triple Gold winner). A fantastic finale for the last night; Jeremy, Dad and Mum have a relaxed final evening.

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- AURORA escape room
- JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)

🏨 **JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai** — last night

← Day 14 Day 16 →

DAY 16 · WED 28 OCT

✈️ Depart Shanghai → Auckland via Hong Kong

Transit ✈️ Overnight flight home

LOCKED IN

13:35 Shanghai Hongqiao → Hong Kong

21:35 Hong Kong → Auckland

📌 Free morning — check out of hotel by late morning

13:35 **Shanghai Hongqiao → Hong Kong** ⏱ 2h 45m ✓ Booked

FLIGHT	CX349 · Airbus A330-300
AIRPORT	Hongqiao (SHA), not Pudong (PVG) — allow time to get there

Arrive Hong Kong 16:20 — 5h15m layover, airside only, no sightseeing.

21:35 **Hong Kong → Auckland** ⏱ ~10h 50m ✓ Booked

FLIGHT	CX113 · Airbus A350-900
ARRIVES	Auckland 13:25, Thursday 29 October

Home.

📍 SHOW YOUR DRIVER

- Shanghai Hongqiao Airport, Terminal 2
- JI Hotel The Bund (Shanghai)

🏠 **Home — Auckland** Thu 29 Oct 13:25

← Day 15 Overview →

CHINA 2026

Booking checklist

Ordered by urgency — tick off as you go. State saves in your browser.

Progress 10 / 15 done

🔴 BOOK NOW — SELLS OUT WEEKS AHEAD

Shanghai Disneyland

Book now · Shanghai · Day 14

📅 Mon 26 Oct · ~09:00 arrival · 🕘 3 tickets: Vincent, Tom, Sharon

💴 ¥499 / ~NZ$125 pp standard (¥1,497 / ~NZ$374 for 3)

Price depends on the date: Mon 26 Oct is ¥499 / ~NZ$125 per standard adult ticket (ages 12–59), among the cheapest days — weekends are ¥569–689 / ~NZ$142–172. Max 5 tickets per order. Book online on the official site before it sells out.

↗ Shanghai Disney tickets

🟠 BOOK SOON — 1–3 WEEKS AHEAD

AURORA escape room (Mr. & Mrs. Jawn, Shanghai)

Book soon · Shanghai · Day 15

📅 Tue 27 Oct · 20:20 suggested (115 min) · 🕘 English · 3 players: Vincent, Sharon, Tom

💴 CNY 288 / ~NZ$72 pp (864 total) · pay on arrival

Groups under 4 must email xingkuan50@gmail.com first (room is 4–7). No deposit; confirmation email with booking code within 24 hrs. Free cancellation 48+ hrs before, 50% refund 24–48 hrs. Alternatives that evening: 19:15 or 21:25. Flight home is 13:35 the next day.

↗ Book AURORA

Shaanxi History Museum

Book soon · Xi'an · Day 7 afternoon

📅 Mon 19 Oct · arrive ~15:30 · 🕘 Timed entry — limited slots · 💴 Free

Free but timed entry must be booked online. Foreigners can book via WeChat mini-program or official site. Slots fill within days of release.

↗ Official museum site

Sun Yat-sen Mausoleum (Nanjing)

Book soon · Nanjing · Day 13

📅 Sun 25 Oct · 🕘 1–7 days in advance · 💴 Free (ticket required)

Online reservation required — book via Nanjing Tourism WeChat mini-program or Trip.com. Sunday in peak season, so book when the window opens. Ming Xiaoling nearby: 3 days ahead.

🟡 ARRANGE IN ADVANCE — NO STRICT WINDOW

🟢 FLEXIBLE — WALK-IN OR SHORT NOTICE FINE

Beijing Wildlife Park

Walk-in fine · Beijing · Day 6

📅 Sun 18 Oct · Opens 8:30am · 💴 ¥80 / ~NZ$20 + ¥20 / ~NZ$5 safari ride pp

No advance booking required. Arrive early for best panda viewing. Arrange transport to Daxing beforehand: Line 4 to Tiangongyuan then park bus, or private car (~50 min).

✅ ALREADY BOOKED — NOTHING TO DO

Hand-Pulled Noodles class (The Hutong)

Confirmed ✓ · Beijing · Day 5

📅 Sat 17 Oct · 10:30–13:00 · 🕘 Teacher: Sophia · 4 adults (Vincent, Sharon, Jeremy, Tom)

💴 CNY 1,400 / ~NZ$350 total (¥350 / ~NZ$88 pp) — paid ✓

Booking #31610091176251. Paid in full (CNY 1,400 / ~NZ$350). Contact +86 159 0104 6127 or WeChat TheHutongEducation.

Forbidden City small-group tour

Confirmed ✓ · Beijing · Day 4

Fri 16 Oct · 10:00 tour · Treasure Hall + Clock Hall · English guide · 4 adults + 2 seniors

Booking #1486591937937097. Meet at the Meridian Gate; entry window 08:30–09:00 (guide confirms the day before). Bring passports. Support WeChat 18510913636.

Shanghai ⇄ Nanjing trains (G452 / G1785)

Confirmed ✓ · Nanjing · Day 13

Sun 25 Oct · out 07:55 → 08:56 · back 21:59 → 23:30

CNY 1,962 / ~NZ$490 total (6 passengers) · ¥327 / ~NZ$82 pp

Outbound #1486592527640427, return #1486592527656735. 2nd class, all six. Be at the station 60 min early. Not all seated together on the way out.

Mount Hua group tour (admission + cable car + coach)

Confirmed ✓ · Xi'an · Day 9

Wed 21 Oct · 07:00 pick-up · Vincent, Jeremy, Sharon, Tom + Dad · full day

See the Trip.com e-receipt

Booking #1486592033825069. Pick-up inside the second ring road or meet at Shijiajie station (Line 3) exit C1 at 07:45–08:00. Bring passports. Supplier 029-82498353 / 029-89284460. Return time isn't stated — check with the supplier.

Summer Palace Guided Tour

Confirmed ✓ · Beijing · Day 2

Wed 14 Oct · Afternoon session · English guide · 2.5 hrs · East Palace Gate entry

CNY 1,308 / ~NZ$327 total (4 adult + 2 senior, incl. cruise) · ~¥218 / ~NZ$55 pp avg

Booking #1486591927947958. Admission + Kunming Lake cruise included. Free cancellation if requested by 17:00 on 13 Oct local time.

Red Theatre Acrobatic Show

Confirmed ✓ · Beijing · Day 2

Wed 14 Oct · 17:40 show · Meet at Red Theatre at 17:40

CNY 2,568 / ~NZ$642 total (6 standard · Green mid rows 14–16) · ¥428 / ~NZ$107 pp

Booking #1486591927971168. Green section, rows 14–16. Meet at the theatre (No. 44 Xingfu Street, by Temple of Heaven East Gate) at 17:40; collect tickets at the Main Hall front desk. A taxi from the hotel, not a walk.

Mutianyu Great Wall — ticket, cable car & coach

Confirmed ✓ · Beijing · Day 3

Thu 15 Oct · 08:30 departure · Xuanwumen Subway Station Exit G · ~5 hrs at the Wall

CNY 1,530 / ~NZ$382 total (6 tickets) · ¥255 / ~NZ$64 pp

Booking #1486591928109095. Regular ticket + round-trip in-attraction shuttle + round-trip cable car + coach from Beijing (drops near the Bird's Nest & Water Cube). Passport ID required. Free cancellation by 18:00 on 14 Oct.

Beijing → Xi'an bullet train (G365)

Confirmed ✓ · Transit · Day 7

Mon 19 Oct · 09:55 → 14:05 · Beijing West → Xi'an North · 4h10m · Booked via Trip.com

G365 (China Rail). Arrives 14:05, so the Shaanxi History Museum visit that afternoon is tight (closes 17:00).

Terracotta Warriors English-guided tour

Confirmed ✓ · Xi'an · Day 8

Tue 20 Oct · 07:40 pick-up · Carpool tour · morning option · no Huaqing Palace

CNY 1,860 / ~NZ$465 total (6 adults) · ¥310 / ~NZ$78 pp

Booking #1486591928609715. Door-to-door pick-up from the hotel (Aihaosen / AHS-Park, Bell Tower). Pick-up and drop-off times may change — check the travel notification. Free cancellation by 22:00 on 19 Oct.

Xi'an → Shanghai flight (HU7845)

Confirmed ✓ · Transit · Day 11

Fri 23 Oct · 08:30 → 11:00 · Xianyang T3 → Shanghai Pudong T2

Hainan Airlines · Economy · 6 pax

Booking #1486591468940666, airline ref NV485F. Lands at Pudong (PVG), not Hongqiao — take Metro Line 2 to the hotel.

CHINA 2026

Accommodation

Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai — confirmed bookings via Trip.com: hotels, rooms, check-in and check-out dates, and confirmed flights. Chinese names and addresses are included to show taxi drivers.

CONFIRMED FLIGHTS

FLIGHT	ROUTE	DEPARTURE	ARRIVAL	AIRCRAFT
CX7402 Cathay Pacific / Air NZ	Auckland → Hong Kong	Tue 13 Oct · 11:15	Tue 13 Oct · 17:45	Boeing 787-9
CX344 Cathay Pacific	Hong Kong → Beijing	Tue 13 Oct · 19:00	Tue 13 Oct · 22:25	Airbus A330-300
HU7845 Hainan Airlines	Xi'an → Shanghai Pudong	Fri 23 Oct · 08:30	Fri 23 Oct · 11:00	Xianyang T3 → Pudong T2
CX349 Cathay Pacific	Shanghai → Hong Kong	Wed 28 Oct · 13:35	Wed 28 Oct · 16:20	Airbus A330-300
CX113 Cathay Pacific	Hong Kong → Auckland	Wed 28 Oct · 21:35	Thu 29 Oct · 13:25	Airbus A350-900

ACCOMMODATION OVERVIEW

Beijing

Tue 13 Oct – Mon 19 Oct

6

nights

Chongwenmen Hotel

Check-in: Tue 13 Oct (late — 22:25 arrival)
Check-out: Mon 19 Oct (morning — train to Xi'an)

Xi'an

Mon 19 Oct – Fri 23 Oct

4

nights

AHS-Park Hotel

Check-in: Mon 19 Oct (afternoon — train arrives 14:05)
Check-out: Fri 23 Oct (early morning — HU7845 departs 08:30)

Shanghai

Fri 23 Oct – Wed 28 Oct

5

nights

JI Hotel, The Bund

Check-in: Fri 23 Oct (flight lands Pudong 11:00 — drop bags if the room isn't ready)
Check-out: Wed 28 Oct (midday — flight departs 13:35)

Beijing 6 nights · Tue 13 Oct – Mon 19 Oct

Chongwenmen Hotel (北京崇文門飯店) · No. 2 Chongwenmen West Street, Dongcheng District, Beijing 100062 · +86-10-65122211-0
地址：崇文門西大街2號, 東城區, 北京, 100062 · 電話：+86-10-65122211-0
Near metro, Tiananmen Square, Wangfujing, Forbidden City and Temple of Heaven

ROOM 1	Business Standard Room · 2 single beds · Jeremy LEE · breakfast included · Pay at hotel (CNY 3,086 / ~NZ$772)
ROOM 2	Regular Double Bed Room · 1 double bed · Bill LEE + Sharon Lee · breakfast included · Pay at hotel (CNY 5,898 / ~NZ$1,474)

Beijing check-in note: The group arrives late on 13 Oct (22:25). Please ensure the hotel is aware of the late check-in and that rooms are held. Check-out on 19 Oct before the morning bullet train to Xi'an.

Xi'an 4 nights · Mon 19 Oct – Fri 23 Oct

AHS-Park Hotel (Huimin Street, Bell Tower Subway Station Store) · 艾豪森酒店（西安回民街鐘樓地鐵站店） · No. 351 East Street, Beilin District, Xi'an · +86-18909238389, +86-29-87369055
地址：東大街351號, 碑林區, 西安 · 電話：+86-18909238389, +86-29-87369055

ROOM 1	Aiqing Twin Room · 2 single beds · Vincent LEE · breakfast included · NZD 305.20 paid
ROOM 2	Double Bed Room · 1 queen bed · Sharon Lee + Bill LEE · breakfast included · NZD 630.40 paid · includes one-way airport pick-up for 2

Xi'an check-in note: Afternoon arrival on 19 Oct (bullet train from Beijing). The room includes a one-way airport pick-up for 2 — you arrive by train, so use it for the early transfer to Xianyang Airport on 23 Oct (HU7845 departs 08:30) and confirm it with the hotel.

Shanghai 5 nights · Fri 23 Oct – Wed 28 Oct

JI Hotel (Shanghai The Bund Sichuan Middle Road) (全季酒店（上海外灘四川中路店）) · No. 607 Sichuan Middle Road, Huangpu District, Shanghai · +86-21-63215050
地址：四川中路607號, 黃浦區, 上海 · 電話：+86-21-63215050

ROOM 1	Twin Bedroom · 2 single beds · Vincent LEE · NZD 904.27 paid
ROOM 2	Superior Panoramic Double Room · 1 queen bed · Bill LEE + Sharon Lee · NZD 1,867.88 paid

Shanghai check-in note: Late-morning arrival on 23 Oct (HU7845 lands at Pudong 11:00) — ask the hotel to hold bags if the room isn't ready. Check-out by late morning on 28 Oct — flight departs Shanghai **Hongqiao (SHA)**, not Pudong (PVG). Allow at least 2 hours before the 13:35 departure.

CHINA 2026

Extra Activities

Off the tourist trail, matched to what everyone enjoys, plus ideas still to research. Filter by city, person, type, and language ease.

CITY

Beijing (3) | Xi'an (6) | Shanghai (12)

PERSON

Everyone (3) | Vincent (2) | Jeremy (1) | Sharon (1) | Tom (1) | Mum (1)

TYPE

All types (3) | Food & drink (1) | Gaming (1) | Shopping (1) | Authentic local (1)

LANGUAGE REQUIREMENT

All (3) | ✅ No language needed (3)

✅ **No language needed** — walk-in, visual, or calculator-haggling

⚠️ **Needs English operator** — book through an English-language service in advance

3 activities in Beijing

GAMING

🎮 Wudaokou gaming arcades & board game cafés

The Wudaokou university district doubles up perfectly — multi-floor gaming arcades with rhythm games, VR, and crane machines, plus a cluster of board game cafés with thousands of titles (many playable without Chinese). Historically-themed Chinese strategy games (Three Kingdoms etc.) are widely available — great for Tom's crossover interest. A natural guys' evening for Vincent, Jeremy, and Tom. Very cheap, very local.

FOOD — AUTHENTIC & LOCAL

🥣 Local canteen breakfast — jianbing & douzhir

Beijing's street breakfast culture is extraordinary and almost entirely missed by tourists. Jianbing (an egg and chilli crêpe cooked on a griddle in front of you) is the iconic one. The real foodie test is douzhir — a fermented mung bean milk that Beijingers drink with fried dough rings. Sharply divisive but worth trying. Find it at a neighbourhood canteen before 9am. A genuinely authentic food experience that costs almost nothing.

SHOPPING — DEALS & BARGAINS

🛍️ Silk Street Market (Xiushui)

The classic Beijing bargain market — a multi-floor indoor venue with silk, cashmere scarves, clothing, jewellery, and souvenirs at heavily negotiable prices. Start at 20–30% of the asking price and walk away slowly — they'll call you back. By NZ standards even a "bad" deal is excellent value. No language needed beyond a calculator and stubborn body language.

CHINA 2026

Confirmations

Everything that's booked, in date order, with booking numbers, meeting points, contacts and cancellation deadlines. Booking PINs and passport numbers aren't stored here — they're in the confirmation emails.

Coming up: Summer Palace free cancellation ends 17:00 on 13 Oct · Mutianyu 18:00 on 14 Oct · Terracotta tour 22:00 on 19 Oct (all Beijing time).

TUE 13 OCT

11:15 CX7402 Auckland → Hong Kong

DETAILS Cathay Pacific / Air NZ · arrives 17:45

THEN CX344 Hong Kong → Beijing 19:00, arrives 22:25

Day 1 →

WED 14 OCT

Afternoon Summer Palace guided tour

#1486591927947958

DETAILS English guide · East Palace Gate · cruise included · exact start time TBC

PEOPLE 4 adults + 2 seniors

Free cancel until 17:00, 13 Oct

Day 2 →

17:40 Red Theatre acrobatic show

#1486591927971168

TICKETS 6 · Green section, mid rows 14–16

COLLECT Front desk in the Main Hall — show the confirmation message

WHERE No. 44 Xingfu Street, Dongcheng District (Line 5 to Temple of Heaven East Gate, exit B)

CONTACT +86 186 0020 8126 · WeChat lucy18600208126

Day 2 →

THU 15 OCT

08:30 Mutianyu Great Wall (ticket, cable car, coach)

#1486591928109095

MEET Xuanwumen Subway Station Exit G (also lists 08:00 at Zhushikou Exit D — check the travel notification)

BRING Passports — ID required

PEOPLE 6 tickets

Free cancel until 18:00, 14 Oct

Day 3 →

FRI 16 OCT

10:00 Forbidden City small-group tour

#1486591937937097

TOUR Treasure Hall + Clock Hall · English guide · tickets included

MEET Meridian Gate ticket gate · entry window 08:30–09:00 (12:30–13:30 also listed) — the guide contacts you the day before

BRING Passports (the ID used for booking)

PEOPLE 4 adults + 2 seniors

SUPPORT WeChat 18510913636

Day 4 →

SAT 17 OCT

10:30 **Hand-Pulled Noodles class (The Hutong)** #31610091176251

WHERE 东城区九道湾中巷1号, Beijing 100007
PEOPLE Vincent, Sharon, Jeremy, Tom
PAID CNY 1,400 — paid in full
CONTACT +86 159 0104 6127 · WeChat TheHutongEducation · events@thehutong.com

Day 5 →

MON 19 OCT

09:55 **G365 Beijing West → Xi'an North**

ARRIVES 14:05
BOOKED VIA Trip.com — booking number not recorded here, check the app

Day 7 →

TUE 20 OCT

07:40 **Terracotta Warriors English-guided tour** #1486591928609715

PICK-UP 07:40 at the hotel — times can change, check the travel notification
PEOPLE 6 adults

Free cancel until 22:00, 19 Oct

Day 8 →

WED 21 OCT

07:00 **Mount Hua group tour** #1486592033825069

PICK-UP 06:50–07:30 (senior 07:00–07:20) inside Xi'an's second ring road, or Shijiajie station (Line 3) exit C1 at 07:45–08:00
INCLUDED Admission, round-trip cable car, coach
BRING Passports — real-name entry check
PEOPLE Vincent, Jeremy, Sharon, Tom + Dad (senior)
CONTACT Supplier 029-82498353 / 029-89284460

Day 9 →

FRI 23 OCT

08:30 **HU7845 Xi'an → Shanghai Pudong** #1486591468940666

FLIGHT Hainan Airlines · Xianyang T3 → Pudong T2 · lands 11:00
AIRLINE REF NV485F
LEAVE HOTEL By about 05:45

Day 11 →

SUN 25 OCT

07:55 **G452 Shanghai Hongqiao → Nanjing South** #1486592527640427

ARRIVES 08:56 · gate 16A/16B (can change)

SEATS Car-seat: Vincent 13-003F · Tom 13-002D · Sharon 13-002C · Dad 13-003A · Mum 11-010D · Jeremy 12-015F

ARRIVE EARLY At the station at least 60 minutes before

Day 13 →

21:59 **G1785 Nanjing South → Shanghai Hongqiao** #1486592527656735

ARRIVES 23:30 · gate A12 (can change)

SEATS Car-seat: Vincent 05-004D · Tom 05-005D · Sharon 05-004B · Dad 05-004F · Mum 05-005B · Jeremy 05-005A

Day 13 →

WED 28 OCT

13:35 **CX349 Shanghai Hongqiao → Hong Kong**

DETAILS Departs from Hongqiao (SHA), not Pudong · arrives 16:20

THEN CX113 Hong Kong → Auckland 21:35, arrives Thu 29 Oct 13:25

Day 16 →

HOTELS

13–19 Oct **Chongwenmen Hotel, Beijing**

ADDRESS 北京崇文門飯店 · No. 2 Chongwenmen West Street, Dongcheng District, Beijing 100062

PHONE +86-10-65122211-0

19–23 Oct **AHS-Park Hotel, Xi'an (Bell Tower)**

ADDRESS 艾豪森酒店（西安回民街鐘樓地鐵站店） · No. 351 East Street, Beilin District

PHONE +86-18909238389 · +86-29-87369055

23–28 Oct **JI Hotel The Bund, Shanghai**

ADDRESS 全季酒店（上海外灘四川中路店） · No. 607 Sichuan Middle Road, Huangpu District

PHONE +86-21-63215050